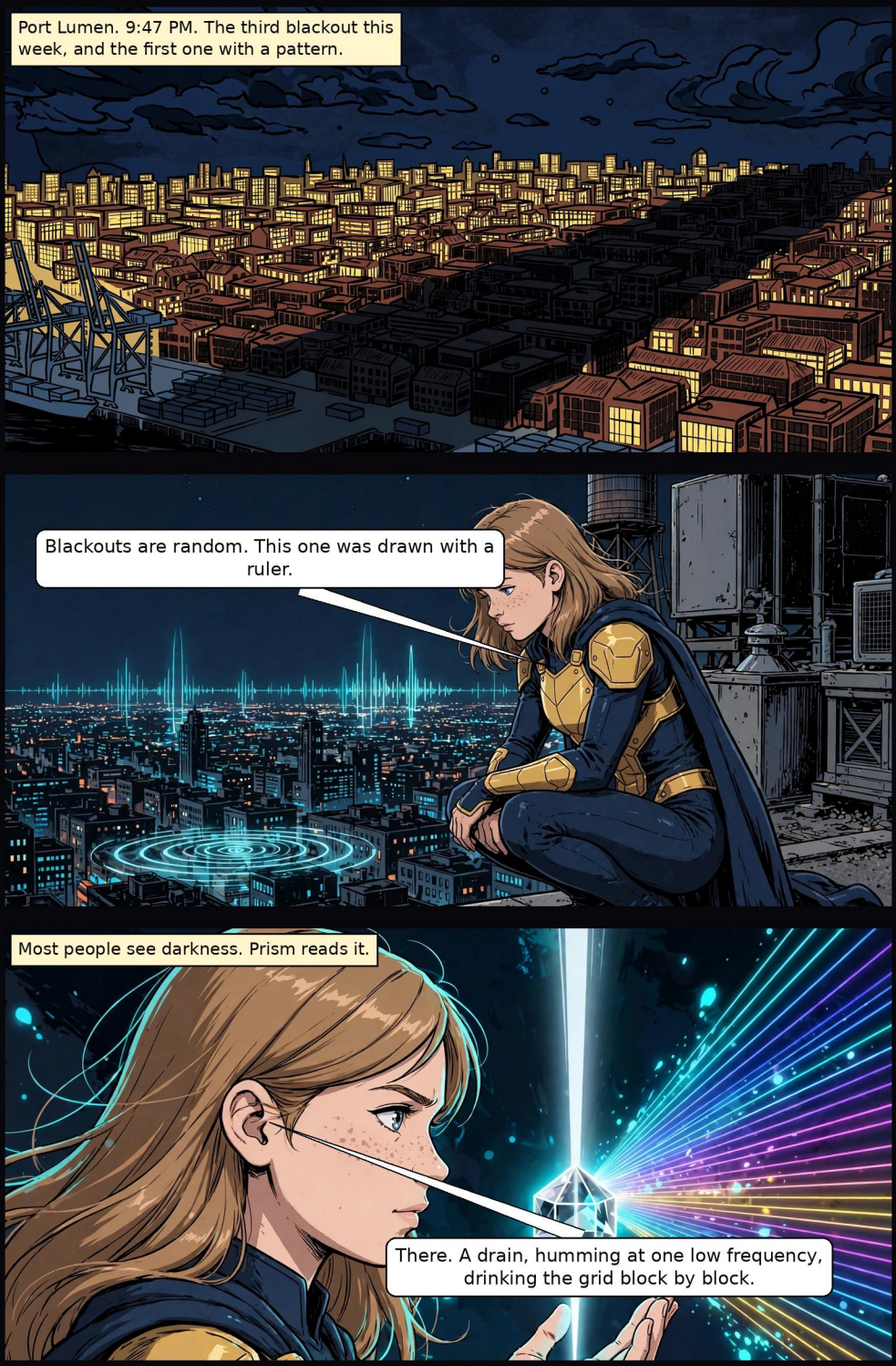
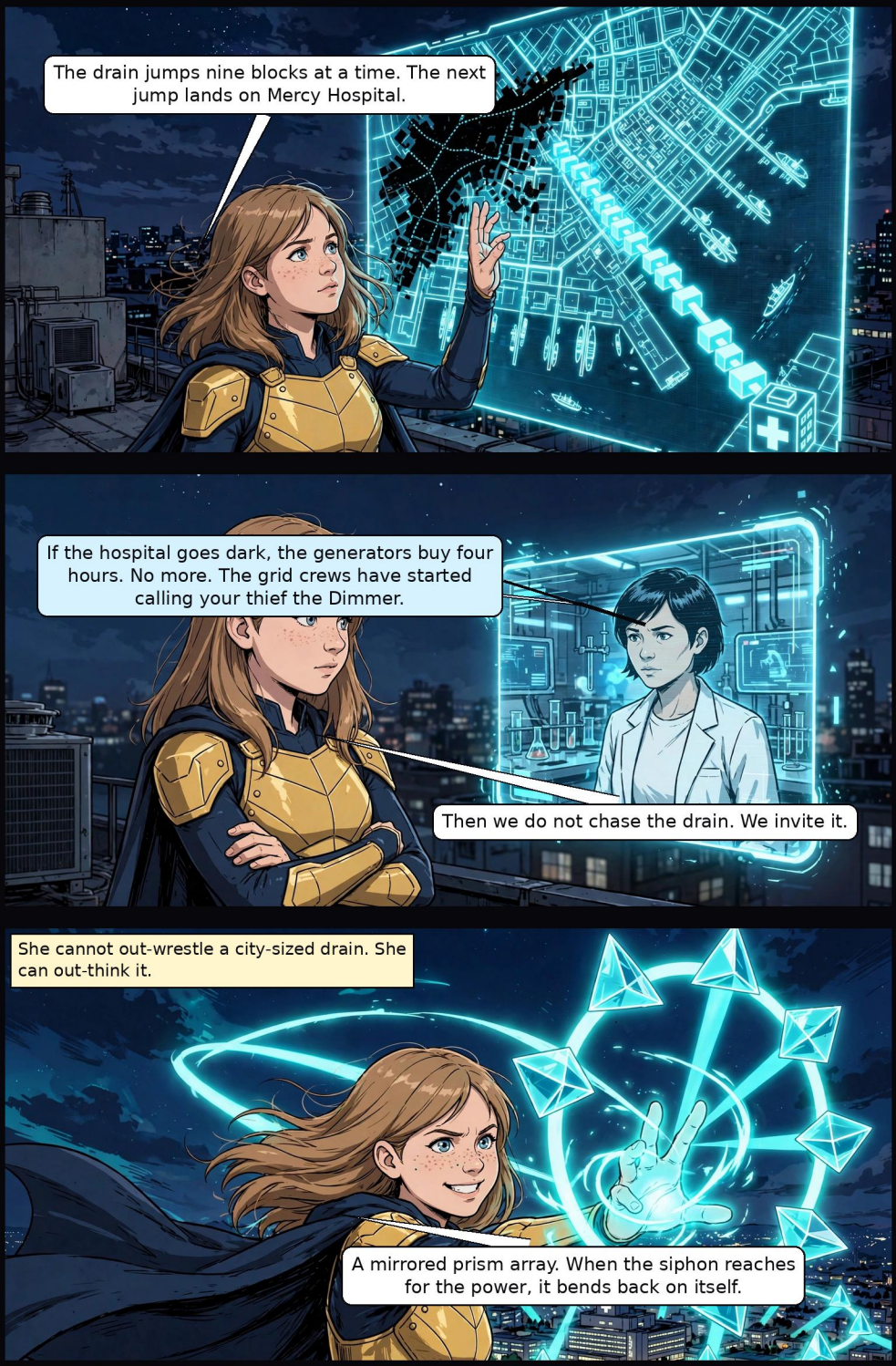
PRISM

Issue 1: The Night the Lights Went Wrong




Port Lumen. 9:47 PM. The third blackout this week, and the first one with a pattern.
Blackouts are random. This one was drawn with a ruler.
Most people see darkness. Prism reads it.
There. A drain, humming at one low frequency, drinking the grid block by block.


Dr. Okafor, tell me Helios has a sensor near Pier Nine.
Reading you, Prism. It does not. Whatever that is, it is not ours.
Prism! Over here!
Stay calm. Light is on its way, one crossing at a time.
Every drain leaves an echo. This one is tuned, like it is listening back.
A frequency she has never read before.

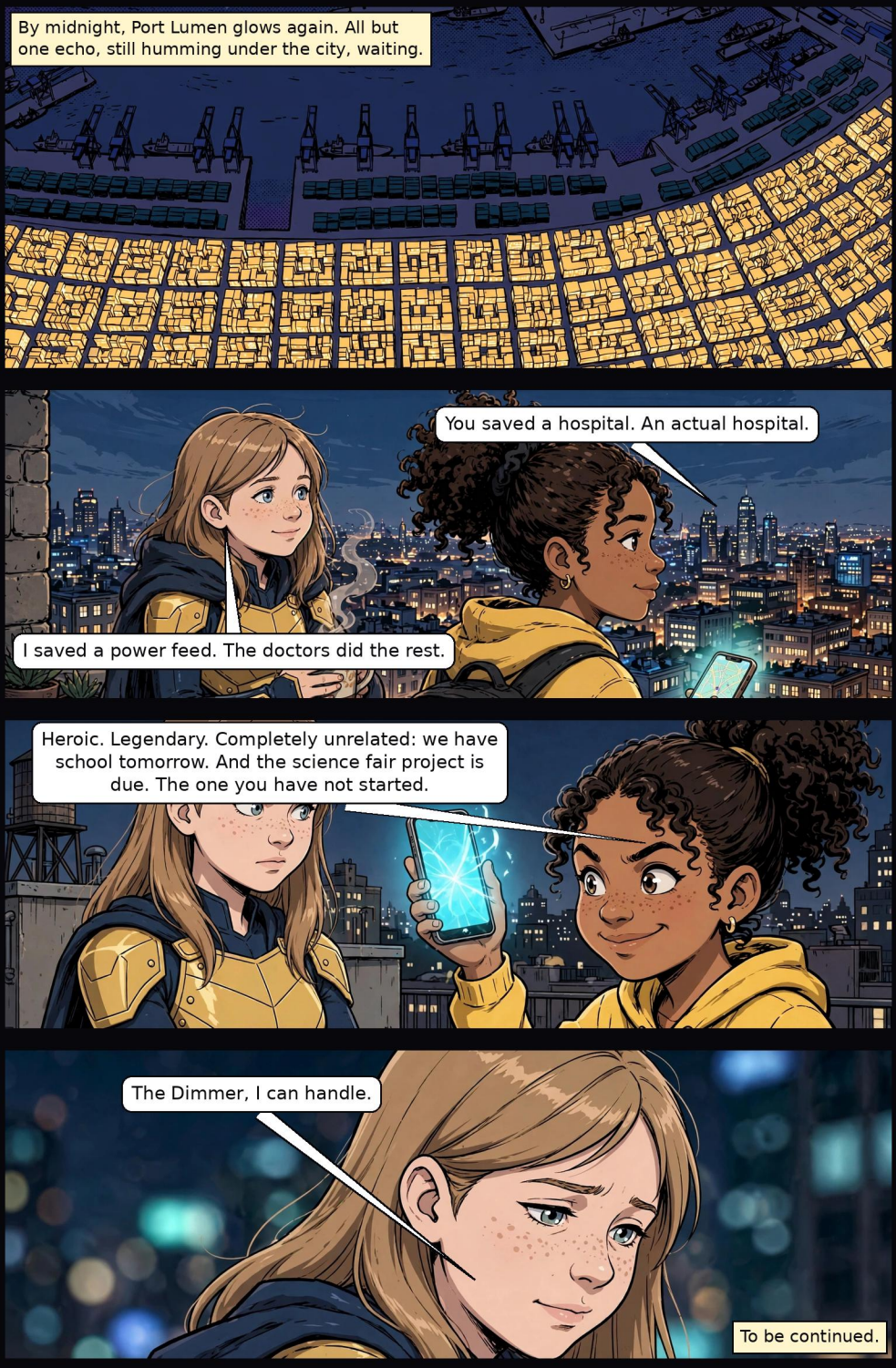

The drain jumps nine blocks at a time. The next jump lands on Mercy Hospital.
If the hospital goes dark, the generators buy four hours. No more. The grid crews have started calling your thief the Dimmer.
Then we do not chase the drain. We invite it.
She cannot out-wrestle a city-sized drain. She can out-think it.
A mirrored prism array. When the siphon reaches for the power, it bends back on itself.

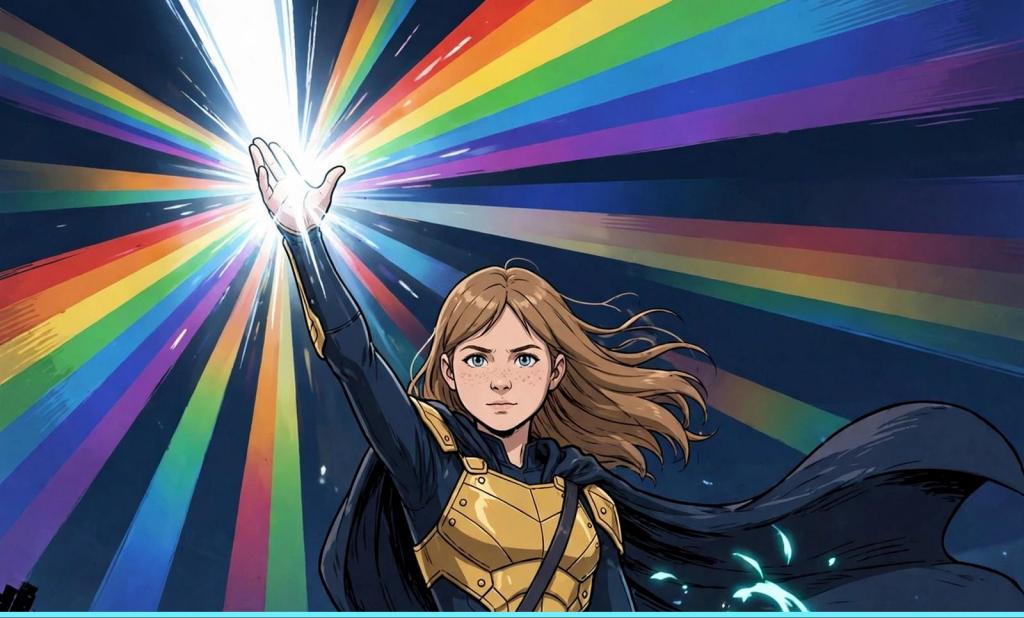

Eleven prisms. Eleven mirrors. One very patient trap.
TINK
Come on. Take the bait. The hospital feed looks delicious, does it not?
VWOOM
Got you.


KRAKLE
A siphon is just light moving the wrong way. So MOVE.


Beneath the city, the Dimmer watches his blackout pattern spread. District by district, Port Lumen goes dark on schedule.
Impossible. Who turns a siphon back on itself?
A defender, then. Next time I take the light she cannot bend.


FWOOSH
The hospital stays lit. Your move, Dimmer.


By midnight, Port Lumen glows again. All but one echo, still humming under the city, waiting.
You saved a hospital. An actual hospital.
I saved a power feed. The doctors did the rest.
Heroic. Legendary. Completely unrelated: we have school tomorrow. And the science fair project is due. The one you have not started.
The Dimmer, I can handle.
To be continued.



Next issue, Prism follows the echo. You choose where she starts.

A **Follow the signal's echo back to Helios Labs.**

B **Intercept the blacked-out convoy at the Port Lumen docks.**

Tell Dad which one you pick, and the next issue runs on it.